UK Study Visa Guide

The United Kingdom (UK) is considered the most popular and prestigious Country for Higher Education in the World. The UK is the home of some of the oldest Universities and colleges which dates back to almost the 12th Century so coming from such solid inheritance, Education in the UK has become a benchmark for different Countries.

The UK has maintained high standards in Higher Education as there are Four UK Universities that are ranked in the Top 10 universities in the world. Getting UK Study Visa is a dream for many Study Abroad Aspirants. The UK has always been a top priority for Study Abroad Aspirants as it attracts thousands of International Students from all over the world every year.

Top Reasons why Study Abroad Aspirants choose the UK as their Study Abroad Destination are:

- ✔ It offers Top Quality Education
- ✔ Modern Educational Approaches
- ✔ Short Duration Courses
- ✔ Great Work Opportunities
- ✔ Cultural Diversity, Future Prospects,
- ✔ Overall best Educational experience.

The UK Study Visa process differs from other countries as it has its own sets of requirements and process for Study Visa and your acceptance of visa application is fully dependent upon your selected program, Maintenance Of Finances, fulfilling other rules and regulations set by UKVI, and personal interview sessions.

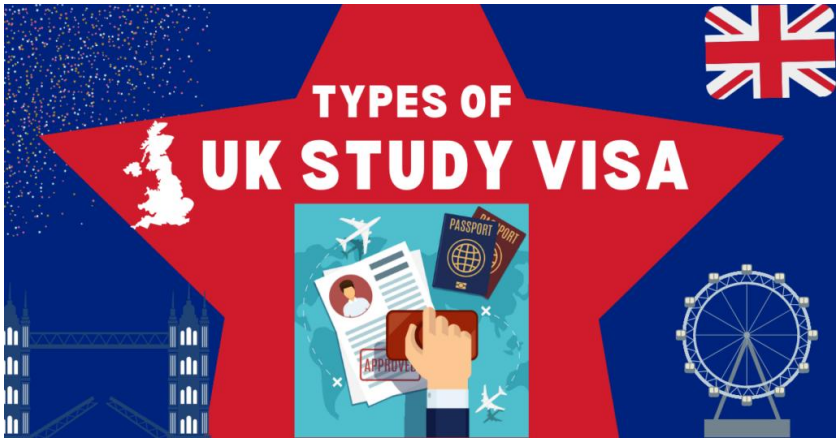
In this article, we've compiled a complete set of information about UK Study Visa Requirements, Types, Documents, Cost, Processing, etc. which will Guide you in Your UK Study Visa Journey.



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Types of UK Study Visa



International Students are eligible for three types of **UK student visa**, Which totally depends upon their choice of the program –

1 – Short-Term Study Visa

Short-Term Study Visa is for those Study abroad applicants who are over 16 years of age and are enrolling in a Short Course or Program of 6-month in a UK Educational institution.
Additionally, applicants enrolling in an 11-month English Language Course are also included in a Short-term Study Visa. The Visa Duration for Short-term Study visa is 6 months and 11 months

2 – Tier 4 student visa (General)

Tier 4 Student Visa (General) is for Applicants that are over 16 years of age and are enrolled in a Course or a program that is longer than 6 months in a UK Educational Institution. The Visa Duration for Tier 4 Student Visa (General) is exactly the duration of the Course or program plus one extra month after completion of the Program.

3 – Tier 4 student visa (child)

Tier 4 Student visa (child) is for Applicants aged between 4 to 17 who want to study at an independent school in the UK. Visa Duration for applicants that are under 16 of age is approximately 6 years plus the extra 4 months after completion of the program. The students that are 16-17 years of age have a visa duration of around 3 years plus extra 4 months.

Note – The majority of applicants applying for higher education in UK Educational Institutions tend to pursue full-time courses or Programs, and therefore, they are required to apply for a Tier 4 student visa.

UK Point-based Visa System



The UK Study Visa eligibility is basically calculated on the point-based system; Applicants have to meet all the requirements of the Immigration Rules and at least have 40 points in total in order to be eligible for a UK Study Visa.

Factors	Points
International Students are required to have a valid Confirmation of Acceptance for their Program from a fully licensed Tier 4 sponsor	**30**
International Students must have enough funds to cover the program fees as well as Living expenses.	**10**

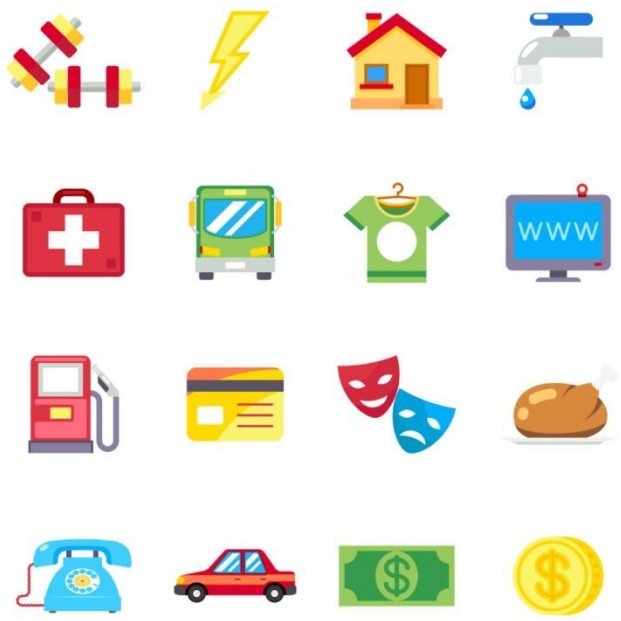
Cost of Study In The UK



Study Program	Average fee (in INR*)
Foundation Programmes	**Rs. – 2.5 lacs per year**
Undergraduate Bachelor Degree	**Rs. – 6 Lacs to 17 Lacs year**
Postgraduate Master's Degree	**Rs. 10 Lacs to 20 Lacs per year**
Doctoral degree	**Rs. 15 Lacs to Rs 24 Lacs per year**

Note: Figures that are mention in a table are just indicative and the cost might differ as Cost may vary according to Course, University in the UK

Cost of Living in the UK



Monthly expenses, costs flat icons. Telephone and Cost Of Living In the UK

Expenses	Approximate cost In (monthly)
Bills (electric/ gas/ water)	**£40 – £50**
Accommodation (halls of residence, usually including bills)	**£400 – £600 per month**
Food and housekeeping	**£160 – £200**
TV licence (mandatory with TV or watching BBC online)	**£12.56 (or £150.50 per year)**
Mobile phone	**£15 – £50**
Clothes and shoes	**£25**
Books & stationery	**£21**
Travel & transport (based on the monthly cost of a student bus pass)	**£32**
Socialising	**£120**
Childcare (if needed)	**£656**
Leisure & sports (calculated on membership for the students' sports center)	**£10 – £20**

Upcoming Intake In The UK



Generally, the academic year in the UK starts from September to July. The majority of Universities / Colleges / Other Educational Institutions in the UK have mainly three intakes which are as follow:

Term - 1 (Intake 1) – Major Intake for the UK starts in **September/October**

Term - 2 (Intake 2) – The second intake generally starts in **January/February**

Term - 3 (Intake 3)– This Intake is available for only selected courses and it starts from **May/June**.

Work As An International Student In the UK



International students who come to the UK to study a full-time undergraduate or full-time postgraduate degree Programme at a recognized university is permitted to work part-time during their studies for up to 20 hours a week and full-time during the holidays.

As far as **post-study work** permits in the UK goes, it's Good news for International students as the Government has increased the duration of Post-study work permit from 4 months to Two years Applicants who start their courses in 2020/21 at the undergraduate level or above are eligible to work or look for work, for a period of **2 years** and after completion of two years, they can convert to a different visa or having to leave the country.

UK Study Visa : Eligibility Requirements



International Students must fulfill all the following sets of requirements in order to apply for a **UK Study Visa** :

1 – Selection of Course or Program and CAS

Study Abroad aspirants looking to apply for a UK student visa, firstly need to apply for an eligible Course in an UK Institution. As a Tier 4 (General) visa applicant, students can pursue one of the following courses:

- A full-time Course or Program which will lead to a qualification that is equal to or higher than NQF – Level 6 (Programs like Graduate Certificate, Diploma, Bachelor's degree, or any other equivalent course)
- A part-time Course or Program which will lead to a qualification that is equal to or higher than NQF level 7 (Program like a PG Certificate , PG diploma, Master's degree or and other equivalent programs)

- A full-time Course or Program which has at least 15 hrs per week day-time study that will lead to a qualification which is equal to or even higher than NQF level 3 (Programs like Higher Education Diploma, I B diploma or any other equivalent course)
- English language Course or Program of B2 Level , which is, Independents user leveling up to a proficient user.
- Recognized Foundation Program, for only postgraduate Doctors or Dentists.

Note – Once Students get admitted to a Program / Course from a University or College approved by UK Visa and Immigration (UKVI),
The applicant will then receive a reference number which is also known as a **Confirmation of Acceptance for Studies (CAS).** One Thing International Students should keep in mind is that they must apply for the UK study visa within Six months of receiving the Confirmation of Acceptance for Studies (CAS).

2 – Financial Requirements

As per Tier 4 UK Student visa rule , International Students are required to provide evidence of Finance to pay for your tuition fees, living expenses, and other miscellaneous expenses, for up to at least a year (9 months). When International Students apply for UK Study Visa they must show that they have :

- At least 12000 GBP (INR – 12,37,016) to cover up your Year-1 (approximately 9 months) course fees.
- Received official financial sponsorship (If applicable)
- Have enough funding to cover the remaining course, exam, and other fees and living costs.

Note – The amount given is just the approximation as the overall amount of funding you are required to showcase entirely depends upon the Course, University, and Location you have chosen to study.

Though as evidence of available funds, you must use one of the following :

- Cash funds in savings or current bank Account.
- Approved Education loan letter
- Letter of financial sponsorship
-

Note – Financial accounts such as shares, bonds, overdrafts, etc cannot be used as proof of funding while applying for a UK Student Visa.

3 – English Language Requirements

Testing English Language ability of an Applicant is an important part of the UK admission and Visa process and most Universities use English language competence test scores as an integral part of their academic evaluation for

the applied Course or Program. Therefore International Students must prove their English Language knowledge by clearing a **SELT** (Secure English Language Test) with CEFR Level B1 and B2.

Most common SELT for UK student visas are **IELTS** and **PTE** which are taken by applicants, the equivalents of CEFR levels for these exams are shown in the table below.

Note – Applicants appearing for SELT must obtain the below scores in each category (Reading,Speaking, Listening , and Writing.)

SELT	IELTS	PTE Academic
Level B1	**4.0 Bands**	**43**
Level B2	**5.5 Bands**	**59**
Level C1	**7.0 Bands**	**76**
Level C2	**8.5 Bands**	**85**

General IELTS Requirement For UK Study Visa by Courses

Courses	IELTS Score
Short-English courses (less than 11 months)	**No IELTS needed**
Foundation	**overall 4.0 Bands**
Undergraduate Degree	**Overall 6.0 Bands with no less than 5.5 in each Category**
Postgraduate Degree	**Overall 6.5 Bands with no less than 6.0 in each Category l**

4 – Immigration Health Service Charge

International students applying for a UK study visa have to pay for a health surcharge of around 470 GBP per year (48652.83 INR) to get access to the **UK's National Health Services**. Applicants have to pay the given amount at the time of submitting their visa application online or if you're applying by post, you then need to pay the surcharge online before you send your application.

Documents Required For UK Study Visa and Admission



When International Students apply for a UK study Visa they need a set of documents. Here are the following documents required before applying for. UK study Visa :

1 – A Valid Passport

Applicants must have a valid passport to apply for a UK Study Visaplus the Passport validity should at least cover 6 months beyond your period of stay in the UK.

2- Passport-sized Colour photographs

Applicants need two colour passport size photographs and the Size of the image should be 45mm X 35mm in size. With the face size of almost 80% of the photographs.

Note – Image should be recent, the background should be plain, Headgear is allowed only for religious apparel only.

3 – Application Form

You need to Fill out a UK study visa application form in order to lodge your application for a UK student visa. (Study Abroad Consultant can guide you in Filling the application form or lodge your application online)

4 – Confirmation of Acceptance for Studies (CAS)

Once applicants successfully get the admission in approved UK Educational Institutions they generate a letter of acceptance also known as **Confirmation of Acceptance for Studies (CAS)** on the chosen course Additionally they give a visa letter which is an official and unconditional offer letter of a place on a course of study. Applicants are required to apply for a visa within 6 months of issuing the Visa letter and if they apply after 6 months visa application will be refused.

Note – Solely getting a visa letter does not guarantee that the application will be successful. The applicant has to fulfill all the other requirements of the immigration rules in order to get a UK study visa.

5 – Evidence of Funds

Applicants need to show the evidence of funds that will cover their Tuition Fees for First year of study and Cost of Living for Nine months. However, the amount applicants need to show depends on many factors like whether they are applying as a child or adult and also whether they will be living in or out of London as the cost of living in London is approximately £11,385 whereas the cost of living outside London is around £9,135.

Note – Applicants should show that they have held the required funds for at least 28 days. The end of that 28 day period must not be more than one month before the application date.

To provide Evidence of funds for UK study Visa Applicants need to showcase the following documents:

- The visa fees payment confirmation receipt
- Tuition Fees pay Slip
- Educational Loan Approved Letter
- Bank Account Statement
- Financial Sponsorship from an international organization approved by UKVI

6 – Secure English Language Test (SELT)

Two most popular SELT are IELTS and PTE so applicants need to get a sufficient score on the SELT in order to apply for a UK Study Visa.

SELT is required as it can act as proof that incoming international students will be able to integrate into the local community and be able to study in the UK without facing any Language barriers.

Note – IELTS Test Score should not be more than 2 year old as the validity of the IELTS is only two years so make sure you apply for the UK study Visa while your Test score is valid.

7 – Education and Work Experience Documents

Applicants need to show all the required academic documents like , 10th -12th Mark Sheets , Degrees , Diploma and other Certifications So keep scannable copies of all the academic documents. In case applicants have work experience they need an experience letter from their previous or current employer. Letter of experience should include all the work details, duration of work, and reference contact. These documents are required for both admissions as well as Study visas.

8 – Letter Of Recommendation (LOR)

This Document is required at the time of admission as the name suggests Letter of Recommendation / LOR /Letter of Reference is a letter which is written by a third party (applicant's professional or academic acquaintance) to the admissions committee to recommend an applicant for admission. LOR describes skills applicants have or an educational training they've received that will help the admission committee to make decisions on applicants' admission.

9 – Statement Of Purpose (SOP)

Another important document which is required at the time for admission in an UK educational institution is SOP which basically is an essay written by students to the Admission Committee and it presents a chance for students to create a good impression by stating their skills, purpose, and goals in front of the admission committee.

10 – Other Documents

Apart from general document mentioned above applicants also need
sets of some other documents for UK study visa which are as follow :

- Tuberculosis screening (if required)
- Assessment documentation
- Proof of No Criminal record

How to Apply for An UK Study Visa



It is recommended that Applicants should start their UK Study visa process 3 months prior to the start of the course.

Step 1 – Arrange Required documents

This is the first step of applying for a UK Study visa so Applicants should start arranging their documents like ID Proof , Marksheets , Work experience letter, Education loan letter, SELT Score, Fees Payslips, Bank Statement, etc which need to be submitted at the Visa Center in order to apply for UK Study Visa.

Step 2 – Apply online

To apply online applicants need to register their profile by creating an online account on the official UK Visa website.After creating an account you can fill out the application form for UK Study Visa after completing the online application form,

You will then need to print out and sign your completed form. To book an appointment at the visa application center you can use an online appointment calendar . After successfully booking the appointment you will receive an email that contains your application number which can be used to track your visa application.

Step 3 – Pay your application fee.

To Successfully lodge your application online you need to pay an application fee and different options have been given to pay the application fees like

- You can pay application fees online using a Visa or MasterCard credit or debit card.
- Pay the visa application fee directly at the visa application center when you submit your visa application.
- Pay your fee by getting a demand draft issued by a nationalized or a foreign bank.

Step 4 – Visit the visa application center

Next step is to book and attend an appointment at the visa application center In order to submit your application and other required documents like fingerprints and facial photographs.

Step 5 – Undertake an interview

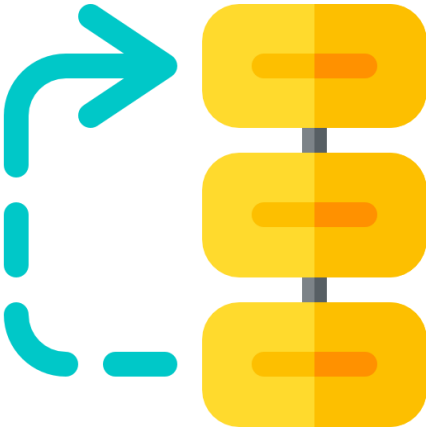
As part of your Student Visa application, Applicants may be asked to attend an interview with a UKVI caseworker In case they want extra information or to even check that you are a genuine student.

UK Student Visa: Processing Time



After applicants submit the biometrics at the Visa application centre files start processing and the process ends after the collection of your passport. The entire process of the UK Study Visa Takes around 3 weeks, wherein, 1 week is 5 working days.

UK Student Visa: Priority Service



Though it takes around 3 week to get the decision on your visa application, Applicants can make this process streamline and get their visa decision delivered fast on a priority basis. To opt for Priority Service You have to contact the visa application center. Currently there are two priority visa collection services available:

- Collection within 24 hours: 800 GBP + 348 GBP (Application fees)
- Collection within 5 days: 500 GBP + 348 GBP (Application Fees)

Note: These priority services for UK Study Visa are limited to very few countries and luckily, India is one of them.

UK Student Visa: Validity & Extension



Students who are studying at a Undergraduate or Postgraduate level can get upto 2 year post study work permit instead of just 4 months . However , The UK Visa Immigration also offers international students a provision to even extend their Study Visa (if you need extra time to complete your current program or are looking forward to starting a new one.)

In order to be eligible for extension of UK student visa, International Students must:

1- Applicants should be present in the UK while starting their application for extension.
2- Need to Fulfill the same eligibility requirements of Tier 4 visa
3- Need to have a sponsor to fund partial or full studies. Sponsor can be-

- Sponsored UK University
- an overseas provider
- an independent school
-

To apply for an extension, International Students must complete an online application form before their current Study visa expires, (At Least 3 months before the commencement course on CAS).

Moreover , International Student need to pay an extra charges for UK study visa extension, which are as follow :

- Extension – £475
- Immigration health surcharge £300 yearly
- Bio-metric Verification £19.20

How can UEMS Ventures assist you in your UK Study visa application?

The Study Abroad Application process is very complex and can be a little overwhelming for a lot of students who are applying for the first time for a UK study Visa as one small mistake can lead to visa application rejection.

That's why you should always rely on UK Study Visa experts like the UEMS Ventures, who have years of experience in filing applications for Students who want to Study in the UK .We can advise you on how to go about the entire process from getting your CAS to preparing your application for a Tier 4 student visa.

We can even help you in the preparation of IELTS and PTE, Loan process, Interview preparation, Travel Assistance, much more so get in touch with UEMS and increase your chance of getting a study visa.

